

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	CHC338 / CHC338P
Subject Title	Chinese Ritual Theories 中國儀式理論
Credit Value	3
Level	3
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	None
Objectives	China is poetically known as the Land of Ritual and Deportment (<i>li yi zhi bang</i> 禮儀之邦). Not surprisingly, a classical passage in the <i>Zuo Tradition</i> (<i>Zuo zhuan</i> 左傳) reads: “The kingdom’s greatest affairs are sacrifice and war” (<i>guo zhi da shi zai si yu rong</i> 國之大事，在祀與戎). This adage entails intriguing questions. Is ritual a fundamental aspect of Chinese culture? How did the redactors of the <i>Zuo Tradition</i> understand ritual? What is sacrifice? What was the relationship between sacrifice and war in ancient times? Was war ritualized? What had Confucius (or his disciples) to say about ritual? What about texts such as the <i>Laozi</i> 老子 and the <i>Zhuangzi</i> 莊子? What is the role of Buddhism and Daoism in the history of Chinese rituals? Exploring these questions, this course will investigate Chinese theories of ritual from the period going to antiquity to the present day. More concretely, we will examine how Confucian, Buddhist, and Daoist proponents described, promoted, and even condemned certain rituals in their writings. In other words, we will explore how Chinese ritualists have conducted the difficult task of verbalizing ideas about what ritual is, why it matters, and how it might transform society. Resorting to the best scholarship available, we will study the history of Chinese ritual theories to achieve a new understanding of Chinese culture.
Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 1)	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) understand the basic patterns of Chinese ritual history; b) achieve a more precise understanding of the relationship between Chinese ritual and institutions such as the state, family, adulthood, marriage, etc. c) grasp the relationship between ritual practice and ethics in imperial and modern China.

	d) understand the links between imperial ritual practices and contemporary ritual practices in China. e) develop the ability to read ritual sources in Chinese as well as conduct fieldwork/participant observation. f) become familiar with ritual theories, both Chinese and Western.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus (Note 2)	We will examine the following topics: 1. Introduction: What is Ritual? 2. Ritual Theory in Early Confucian Classics (<i>Lunyu</i> 論語, <i>Liji</i> 禮記, etc.) and Early Daoist Classics (<i>Laozi</i> 老子, <i>Zhuangzi</i> 莊子, etc.) 3. Six Dynasties Ritual Theory I: Buddhist Scriptures 4. Six Dynasties Ritual Theory II: Daoist Scriptures 5. Sui-Tang Ritual Theory: Confucian and Daoist Developments 6. Song-Yuan Ritual Theory I: Zhu Xi's <i>Jiali</i> 家禮 7. Song-Yuan Ritual Theory II: Daoist Thunder Rites 雷法 8. Song-Yuan Ritual Theory III: Chinese Esoteric Buddhism 9. Ming Ritual Theory I: The Ming State as a Ritual Institution (<i>Daming jili</i> 大明集禮) 10. Ming Ritual Theory II: The Ming State and Daoist Ritual 11. Qing Ritual Theory I: Qing Textualist Scholars on Ritual 12. Qing Ritual Theory II: Qing Daoism and Spirit-Writing 13. Conclusion: Ritual and Chinese Modernity
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	The teacher will lecture students on matters of ritual theory. The lectures will focus on Chinese ritual theories as seen in traditional texts. The students will be required to read both modern articles/books and primary sources beforehand. During the lectures, the teacher will introduce students to concepts in traditional and modern ritual theories. The teacher will also guide students in reading traditional Chinese texts on ritual. These lectures will cultivate in students a more accurate sense of what ritual is and why ritual matters for Chinese civilization.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)					
			a	b	c	d	e	f
	1. Quiz	20	√	√	√	√	√	√
	2. Class participation	20	√	√	√	√	√	√
	3. Final Paper	60	√	√	√	√	√	√
	Total	100 %						
	Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:							
	1) This assignment aims at making the students memorize and thus be able to apply the knowledge about Chinese ritual theories in academic settings.							
	2) This assignment is about letting students be able to verbalize their newly obtained knowledge in real life communication. This way, students will be able to develop a comparative perspective while describing Chinese ritual theories in a more accurate manner.							
	3) The lectures summarize for students a substantial, rich, and relevant body of scholarly literature on rituals. The lectures aim at introducing students to a scholarly mindset that privileges arguments, questions, and innovation. This newly received education should be reflected in the students’ final paper. The teacher will guide the students and explain to them how to write a piece of argumentative writing.							
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:							
	▪ Lectures						26 Hrs.	
	▪ Tutorials (including guided field study):						13 Hrs.	
	Other student study effort:							
	▪ Reading						45 Hrs.	
	▪ Writing						30 Hrs.	
	Total student study effort						114 Hrs.	
Reading List and References	1. Boileau, Gilles. “The Sage Unbound: Ritual Metaphors in the Daode jing.” <i>Daoism: Religion, History and Society</i> 5 (2013): 1–56. 2. Chard, Robert. <i>Creating Confucian Authority: The Field of Ritual Learning in Early China to 9 CE</i> . Leiden: Brill, 2021.							

	3. Davis, Edward. <i>Society and the Supernatural in Song China</i>. Honolulu: University of Hawaii Press, 2001. 4. Ebrey, Patricia. <i>Confucianism and Family Rituals in Imperial China: A Social History of Writing about Rites</i>. New Jersey: Princeton University Press, 1991. 5. Fava, Patrice. <i>Un taoïste n'a pas d'ombre: mémoires d'un ethnologue en Chine</i>. Paris: Buchet-Chastel, 2023. 6. Goossaert, Vincent, and David Palmer. <i>The Religious Question in Modern China</i>. Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2011. 7. Goossaert, Vincent. <i>Heavenly Masters: Two Thousand Years of the Daoist State</i>. Honolulu: University of Hawaii Press; Hong Kong: The Chinese University Press, 2022. 8. Grebnev, Yegor. <i>Mediation of Legitimacy in Early China: A Study of the Neglected Zhou Scriptures and the Grand Duke Traditions</i>. New York: Columbia University Press, 2022. 9. Grimes, Ronald. <i>The Craft of Ritual Studies</i>. New York: Oxford University Press, 2013. 10. Ing, Michael David Kaulana. <i>The Dysfunction of Ritual in Early Confucianism</i>. New York: Oxford University Press, 2012. 11. Keliher, Macabe. <i>The Board of Rites and the Making of Qing China</i>. Berkeley: University of California Press, 2019. 12. Kleeman, Terry. <i>Celestial Masters: History and Ritual in Early Daoist Communities</i>. Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard University Press, 2016. 13. Lagerwey, John. <i>China: A Religious State</i>. Hong Kong: University of Hong Kong Press, 2010. 14. Meulenbeld, Mark. <i>Demonic Warfare: Daoism, Territorial Networks, and the History of a Ming Novel</i>. Honolulu: University of Hawaii Press, 2015. 15. Pines, Yuri. "Disputers of the Li: Breakthroughs in the Concept of Ritual in Preimperial China," <i>Asia Major</i>, 3rd ser. 13.1 (2000), pp. 1–41. 16. Puett, Michael. <i>To Become a God: Cosmology, Sacrifice, and Self-Divinization in Early China</i>. Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard University Press, 2002. 17. Schipper, Kristofer. <i>Le corps taoïste: corps physique, corps social</i>. Paris: Fayard, 1982. 18. 葛兆光, 《何為中國：疆域、族群、文化與歷史》。香港：牛津大學出版社，2014年。 19. 顧希佳, 《禮儀與中國文化》。北京：人民出版社，2001年。 20. 彭林, 《中國古代禮儀文明》。北京：中華書局，2004年。
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	21. 彭林，《中華傳統禮儀讀本》。杭州：浙江文藝出版社，2008年。 22. 沈文倬，《宗周禮樂文明考論》。杭州：浙江大學出版社，1999年。 23. 湯勤福（主編）《中華禮制變遷史》。北京：中華書局，2022年。 24. 吳麗娛（主編），《禮與中國古代社會》（先秦卷、秦漢魏晉南北朝卷、隋唐五代宋元卷、明清卷）。北京：中國社會科學出版社，2016年。 25. 殷慧，《禮理雙彰：朱熹禮學思想探微》。北京：中華書局，2019年。 26. 朱鴻林，《明太祖的治國理念及其實踐》。香港：香港中文大學出版社，2010年。
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

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